



The Sack of Rome in 1527 shocked Europe and devastated the Church. Although it also deeply embarrassed Charles V, it meant his dominance in Italy was confirmed.

THE MOST SHOCKING EVENT OF THE ITALIAN WARS was the **Sack of Rome** in 1527 by Charles V's Imperial troops. It also highlighted the contradictions facing Charles V as he struggled to impose order

on his vast territories. As Holy Roman Emperor, Charles V was the natural ally of the Catholic Church just as he was the natural enemy of Lutheranism (see 1517). Yet not only was Charles now at

war with the papacy's Holy League—assembled to challenge his dominance in Italy—some of the troops who had laid waste to Rome, when his army ran out of control in protest at their unpaid wages were openly sympathetic to the reformist doctrines of Luther. But, while Pope Clement VII cowered in the Castel San' Angelo as churches and palaces were ransacked and nuns raped and priests murdered, it was clear that Charles's control of Italy was now absolute.

Following their victory at Mohács in 1526 and the conquest of much of Hungary in 1529, the **Ottomans** feared the Habsburgs would try to recapture the lost territories and so laid siege to **Vienna**. It proved too ambitious a task even for the formidable Ottoman army, for the weather proved as arduous a foe as the Austrians. A second attempt on the city in 1532 also failed.

After his victory at Panipat in 1526, **Babur** consolidated his hold over north India the following year, defeating a Rajput army under Rana Sanga at the **Battle of Khanwa**. The final establishment of Mughal power came in 1529 with the destruction of an Afghan army at Ghagra.

In 1531, the **Schmalkadic League** was formed. This was a military alliance, made originally between the Lutheran rulers of

Siege of Vienna

The Ottoman siege of Vienna in 1529 failed because of the bad weather—bitter autumn rains and early snow—and over-extended supply lines.



Atahualpa, the last Inca emperor, leads his army at Caxamalca.

SPANISH EXPLORATION AND CONQUEST IN THE NEW WORLD, so decisively reinforced by the subjection of Mexico in 1521, was continued on an even more spectacular scale with the takeover of the Peruvian **Inca Empire** by **Francisco Pizarro** (1476–1541) in 1532. In little more than a year, a force of 188 Spaniards defeated a highly organized state of five million. Like Cortés's invasion of Mexico, its success depended on internal divisions within the Inca Empire, and a combination of religious zeal, greed, and superior military means—steel, guns, and armor against the Incas' weapons of sharpened stones and padded cotton armour—the whole driven by Pizarro, a man of huge ambition.

On the other side of the continent, further European penetration of South America was also taking place, albeit on a far smaller scale. In 1532, Portugal established its first permanent settlement in **Brazil**, at São Vicente. This was the nucleus of what by the end of the century would be a huge colonial enterprise based on slavery and sugar plantations.

In 1532, hostilities between Germany's Schmalkadic League and Emperor Charles V ceased with the signing of a **treaty at Nuremberg**. The concessions made to the Protestants by Charles, which, most importantly, included freedom of worship, were welcomed by Martin Luther and enabled German Protestants to spread throughout the country in the following decade.



SULEIMAN I (1494–1566)

The 46-year rule of Suleiman was marked by a succession of victories in the Balkans, the Middle East, and North Africa that left the Ottomans as the most dynamic and dominant presence in the Western Hemisphere. He is known as "Suleiman the Magnificent" in the West and as *Kanuri*, "The Lawgiver," in the Islamic world, and his reign saw a flowering of Ottoman art and culture.

Hesse and Saxony in northern Germany, under which each promised to aid the other if Charles V attempted, by force, to reimpose Catholicism. It rapidly expanded to include other German Protestant states and gained the support of Charles's external enemies, the Ottomans and France. It was also an opportunity for each territory to enrich itself by taking over church property.



March 17, 1527 Mughal Empire defeats the Rajputs at the **Battle of Khanwa**

May 6, 1527 Unpaid and uncontrolled Imperial armies sack Rome

1528 Portuguese reach Bengal

1528 Publication of Baldassare Castiglione's *Book of the Courtier*

August 3, 1529 Temporary truce created between France and Charles V with the **Peace of Cambrai**

September 27–October 14, 1529 Ottomans unsuccessfully besiege Vienna, Austria

December 26, 1530 Death of **Babur**, founder of the Mughal Empire (b. 1483)

February 27, 1531 German Protestants form the **Schmalkadic League** to resist Charles V

July 1532 Francisco Pizarro launches Spanish conquest of **Inca Peru** (to 1533)

1532 Portuguese establish São Vicente, Brazil

1532 Ottomans defeated in Hungary

1532 Peace of Nuremberg guarantees German Protestant princes freedom of worship

1532 Khanate of Crimea established under Ottoman protection

June 21, 1527 Death of Niccolò Machiavelli (b. 1469), author of *The Prince*

April 6, 1528 Death of German artist Albrecht Dürer (b. 1471)

1528 Safavids take Baghdad

May 6, 1529 Mughals defeat Afghans in the **Battle of Ghagra**

September 8, 1529 Ottomans capture Buda, Hungary

June 25, 1530 The **Augsburg Confession** outlines the key elements of the Lutheran faith

1530 Portuguese begin colonization of **Brazil**

1531 Charles V outlaws Protestantism in the **Netherlands**